

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Vincent Van Faux

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Vincent Van Faux

Celebrated Contemporary Painter

Vincent believes even his shopping lists belong in a documentary. He is truly a genius of the visual arts. Vincent became famous young and has been trying ever since to convince people that this is not the same thing as becoming famous accidentally.

- Went to art school with **Dada DiCapo**. **Dada** enjoys reminding Vincent of this in front of collectors.
- **Hugh Bidder** wants to represent Vincent. Vincent has yet to approve **Hugh**'s percentage.
- **Penny Pincher** keeps showing Vincent photos of paintings and asking what they are worth. He's not interested.
- **Al Baster** compares their commissions by weight. Vincent would prefer to discuss the price.

ACTING TIPS

Warm, competitive, mercurial, self-aware enough to joke about his ego but not enough to lose it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Vincent Van Faux. My new work is here tonight. My early work is also here, despite several very expensive objections.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

Your other secret

You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Ella Gance knows you were behind the anonymous buybacks.
- Persuade Claire O'Scuro that the student painting should not be displayed.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1** *Look inside the vessel that usually gives cut flowers a place to stand.*
- 2** *Find the green light, then examine the space nearby.*
- 3** *Find the biography of the man who chose conscience over obedience. Its pages have company.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE



Vincent Van Faux

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant was displaying my student painting beside my mature work. I have been buying the early disasters through intermediaries. Vanity costs more when it has provenance. During the live portrait interview, 6:39 to 6:45, I painted a moustache on my younger self. If he insisted on exhibiting the boy, the boy deserved a disguise.

IF MURDERER

Grant intended to exhibit the student painting I have spent years buying back. Yes, I purchase my early work through intermediaries. There are collectors whose taste I prefer to supervise. I did a brief portrait interview, then left the student canvas on its easel. Grant was about to turn it into the evening's most expensive joke.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Vincent Van Faux

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Vincent Van Faux

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I inspected the bowl's glaze early, then worked at the interview easel. After the broadcast I went to the gallery to see which label Grant had approved. He had retained 'Early student work.' I considered something shorter. The producer kept my brushes until I stopped proposing improvements to the lettering.

IF MURDERER

I left the interview easel and went to the gallery. The student label was still waiting for approval. I took it to the outer worktable and considered whether Grant would lend me my own painting. I wished to remove it before he began explaining how generous he was. The red paint was still wet.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Vincent Van Faux

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Vincent Van Faux

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

There is red paint on my cuff and museum linen in my case. I wiped the palette with it. The paint is ordinary oil colour, which Chip will regard as a very incomplete description. I also removed the loan label for my student painting. I wanted that canvas outside the exhibition and preferably outside the country.

IF MURDERER

I kept museum linen in my case and used the setup key to fetch a clean palette. The red mark on my cuff came from the student canvas. I removed its loan label and took it with me. Grant called this tampering with his collection. He had acquired the painting; the humiliation remained mine.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACCUSATIONS



Vincent Van Faux

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I manipulated the market for my own embarrassing work. I also stole a label. But the uncut live portrait puts me at the easel while the coupe was exposed. The moustache develops stroke by stroke on camera. I wished Grant would stop talking about my youth. Someone else found a permanent way to stop him.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I left the easel before the long take. With the setup key I collected the toxin, then wiped it inside Grant's coupe using the linen in my case. He had promised to make a joke of my career. I made my last appeal at the salon, knowing he would soon be unable to tell that joke.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.